Project Report: Digital Literacy and Professional Presence

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INTRODUCTION:

This project helped me understand what digital literacy actually means in real life, not just as a concept. It is not only about using phones or laptops, but also about using the internet in a safe, smart, and responsible way. As a first-year student, I realized that having basic digital skills is very important for studies, communication, and future career opportunities. Through this project, I got to explore different tools and platforms that students commonly use. I also learned about online safety, maintaining a good digital presence, and communicating properly through emails. Overall, this project gave me a better idea of how to use technology in a more meaningful and careful way in my daily academic life.

TASK 1 REPORT:

For Task 1, I created a one-page infographic using Canva. I focused on three topics: what digital literacy means, some useful digital tools for students, and basic internet safety practices. I chose Canva because it is beginner-friendly and makes it easy to create neat and visually attractive designs.

In my infographic, I explained digital literacy in simple words so that anyone can understand it easily. I also mentioned tools like Google Docs and online learning platforms that students use regularly. For internet safety, I added points such as not clicking on unknown links, using strong passwords, and being careful while sharing personal information online.

One thing I found slightly challenging was keeping the design simple while still including all important points. At the same time, it was interesting to see how visuals can make information easier to understand. This task helped me improve my creativity and also taught me how to present information in a clear and simple way.

TASK 2 REPORT:

In Task 2, I created and updated my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are important because they help students build a professional identity online. Before this task, I did not realize how important it is to start early.

On GitHub, I created a profile README where I added basic details about myself and what I want to learn in the future. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details so that my profile looks more complete. On Kaggle, I explored how datasets and competitions work, even though I am still new to it.

In the coming years, I plan to use GitHub to upload my projects, LinkedIn to connect with people and look for opportunities, and Kaggle to slowly improve my skills in data-related areas. This task made me understand that building a strong online presence takes time, and it is better to start now rather than later.

TASK 3 REPORT:

In Task 3, I worked on both coding practice and a collaboration tool. For coding, I used HackerRank and solved a beginner-level problem. Since I am just starting out, it was a good experience to understand how coding questions are structured. It also made me realize that regular practice is important to improve.

For the second part, I created a Google Form with five questions related to digital literacy. I included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions. After that, I checked the responses in Google Sheets, which showed me how data can be collected and viewed in an organized way.

This task was helpful because it introduced me to tools that I will actually use in my college life. HackerRank will help me get better at coding step by step, and Google Forms will be useful for surveys and projects. Overall, it gave me practical exposure to both technical and collaborative tools.

TASK 4 REPORT:

A common example of poor digital communication is when a student sends a very casual or unclear email to a professor. If the email does not have a proper subject line or clear explanation, it can create confusion or may even be ignored.

This problem can be avoided by following simple email etiquette. Writing a clear subject, using a polite greeting, and explaining the purpose properly makes a big difference. Keeping the message short and respectful is also important. From this task, I understood that even small things in communication matter a lot and can affect how others respond to you.

TASK 5 REPORT:

While learning about cybercrime, I was surprised to see how easily people can fall for scams like phishing and online payment fraud. Many of these scams look very real, which makes them difficult to identify, especially for students who are not very aware.

One habit I will change is being more careful before clicking on any link or sharing personal details online. I will also double-check payment requests and avoid trusting unknown sources. This task made me more alert and helped me understand that being careless online can lead to serious problems.

CONCLUSION:

This project was a useful learning experience for me as a first-year student. It helped me understand important concepts like digital literacy, online safety, and professional communication. I also got hands-on experience with platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank, which I will continue using in the future. The tasks were simple but practical, and they showed me how these skills are useful in real life. Overall, this project has helped me become more aware, responsible, and confident in using digital tools for my academic and personal growth.

REFERENCES:

- Canva
- GitHub
- LinkedIn
- Kaggle
- HackerRank
- Google Forms and Google Sheets
- National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)